

AI Workforce Readiness

From AI Awareness to Workplace Capability

A Morocco-Based, Arabic-First Initiative for Practical, Responsible and Accessible AI Adoption in Arabic-Speaking Workplaces

Lahcen Afaadas | Morocco

THE GLOBAL SIGNAL

AI is changing work faster than many organizations can adapt.

Artificial intelligence is moving rapidly from experimentation into everyday work. The challenge is no longer simply access to AI tools — it is whether people and organizations can adapt, learn continuously, redesign work, and turn AI capabilities into meaningful workplace outcomes.

85%

of leaders say building organizational and workforce adaptability is critical.

65%

of organizations say their culture needs significant change because of AI.

7%

say they are leading in helping their workforce continuously grow and adapt.

Source: Deloitte, 2026 Global Human Capital Trends

The emerging challenge is not AI adoption alone — it is workforce adaptation.

THE WORKFORCE GAP

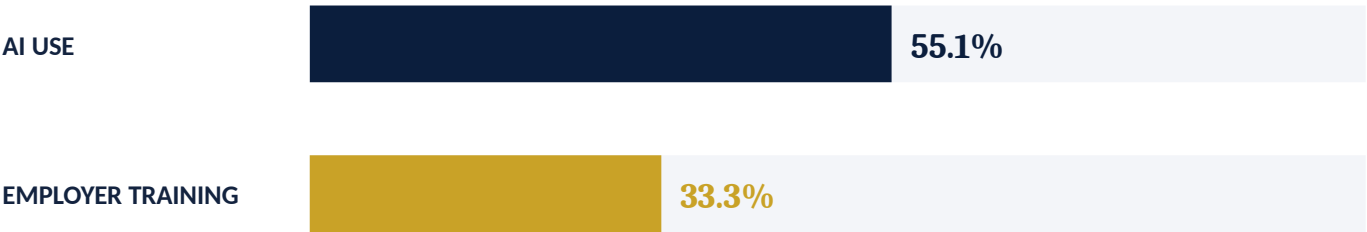
AI Use Is Growing Faster Than AI Training

The gap between AI adoption and workforce preparation is becoming increasingly visible.

- 55.1% of workers use generative AI or AI agents daily or weekly.
- 33.3% have participated in organization-provided AI training in the previous six months.
- 28.3% say their organization provides no AI training at all.

Source: The Conference Board, 2026

AI USE vs. EMPLOYER TRAINING



But the deeper gap is capability.

Many organizations are focusing on AI literacy and basic prompting, while fewer are helping employees develop more advanced capabilities such as integrating AI into workflows or applying it to strategic business challenges. The Conference Board specifically highlights the importance of hands-on experimentation, practical application, dedicated time and managerial support.

Training people to use today's AI is not the same as preparing them for tomorrow's work.

WHY MENA, WHY NOW?

The Arab Region Is Entering a Critical Workforce Transition

Artificial intelligence is no longer a distant technological prospect for the Arab region. It is already affecting job structures, skills demand and sectoral dynamics, with the effects expected to deepen through 2035 — a central finding of the joint ILO–ESCWA report released in May 2026, which highlights the importance of workforce transition, skills development and inclusive AI governance.

Impact does not necessarily mean replacement — it includes jobs exposed to change and jobs that can be enhanced by AI, alongside the emergence of new roles.

~25%

of occupations in the Arab region could be affected by generative AI by 2035, including jobs at risk of displacement and jobs that may be augmented.



The policy challenge is not simply preparing people to use AI — it is preparing them to adapt as work itself changes.

14.6%

of jobs (~8 million) could benefit from AI through augmentation — enhancing human work rather than replacing it.

2.2%

of jobs (~1.2 million) may be exposed to automation by generative AI.

Sources: ILO–ESCWA, Artificial Intelligence and Employment Futures for the Arab Region (2026); ILO, Navigating the digital and AI revolution in Arab labour markets (2025).

Human judgment + AI capability + Continuous learning → Workforce Readiness

WHY MOROCCO?

Morocco: A Strategic Starting Point for an AI Workforce Readiness Pilot

Morocco is entering an important phase of digital transformation, with digital adoption, skills development, job creation and AI innovation increasingly connected to the country's economic agenda. The World Bank's \$250 million Morocco Digital Transformation Acceleration Program supports AI innovation, digital talent, digital jobs, MSME digitalization and capacity building, with measurable results targeted by 2031.

\$250M

World Bank Morocco Digital Transformation Acceleration Program

AI innovation • Digital talent • Digital jobs • MSME digitalization • Capacity building

2031

Target year for measurable results under the World Bank Morocco Digital Transformation Acceleration Program.

Source: World Bank, Morocco Digital Transformation Acceleration Program, approved June 2026.

The initiative is being developed independently by Lahcen Afaadas in Morocco, with a practical focus on Arabic workplace learning. Morocco is proposed as an initial testing ground for a model designed with broader Arabic-speaking markets in mind.

MOROCCO'S DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION ECOSYSTEM



OUR PROPOSITION

From AI Literacy to Workplace Capability

Moving beyond “knowing AI” toward using AI effectively, responsibly and meaningfully at work.



CARE — A Practical Framework for Structuring Effective AI Interactions at Work

C	A	R	E
CONTEXT	ASSIGNMENT / ROLE	REQUEST	EXPECTED OUTPUT
What does AI need to know? Provide the relevant background and situation.	What perspective should AI take? Define the role or expertise required.	What exactly should AI do? Specify the task or objective.	What should the result look like? Define format and quality criteria.
CARE turns an AI conversation into a structured workplace interaction.			

TRADITIONAL AI TRAINING	OUR PROPOSED DIRECTION
Tool awareness	Workplace capability
Generic prompts	Role-specific applications
One-off interactions	Repeatable workflows
AI-generated answers	AI + human judgment

The goal is not to make employees “AI experts.” The goal is to help them become more capable, adaptable and effective in an AI-enabled workplace.

FROM FRAMEWORK TO PRACTICE

Turning AI Knowledge into Everyday Workplace Practice

Rather than teaching AI as a standalone technology, the approach focuses on how employees can integrate AI into the work they already perform.



ROLE-BASED APPLICATION

MANAGEMENT Planning • Reporting • Decision support	FINANCE Analysis • Reporting • Financial workflows	MARKETING Research • Content • Customer insights	HR Recruitment • Job descriptions • Learning
EDUCATION Lesson prep • Assessment • Learning support	ENGINEERING & PROJECTS Documentation • Analysis • Planning	CUSTOMER SERVICE Knowledge support • Response drafting	

The objective is not to teach every employee the same AI skills, but to help different employees discover where AI can create meaningful value in their own work.

THE KNOWLEDGE ASSET

Practical Arabic content • 100+ practical AI applications and prompt examples • 50+ structured tables and visual learning elements • Role-specific workplace examples • Responsible AI guidance • CARE methodology.
The book is the initiative's first knowledge asset — a foundation for guided learning, workplace practice and pilot testing.

ARABIC-FIRST. GLOBALLY INFORMED.

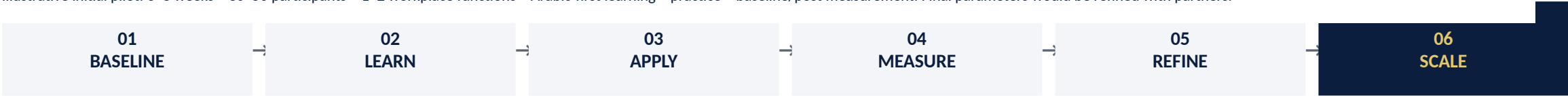
The initiative is designed primarily for Arabic-speaking employees while drawing on global research, international evidence and evolving AI practices — human judgment, output verification, privacy awareness and responsible use throughout.

The intended outcome is not more AI usage for its own sake — but better work through informed, responsible and purposeful AI use.

From Concept to Evidence

Rather than assuming the proposed approach will work, we want to test, measure, learn and improve it.

Illustrative initial pilot: 6–8 weeks • 30–50 participants • 1–2 workplace functions • Arabic-first learning + practice • baseline/post measurement. Final parameters would be refined with partners.



WHAT WOULD WE MEASURE?

AI Confidence Do participants feel more capable of using AI appropriately?	Task Performance Can AI-assisted workflows improve selected workplace tasks?	Output Quality Does structured AI use improve the quality of outputs?	Efficiency Can participants complete selected tasks more efficiently?
Verification Can participants identify errors or inappropriate outputs?	Workflow Adoption Do participants keep using AI-assisted workflows after training?	Responsible AI Greater awareness of privacy, verification and oversight?	

OUR CORE HYPOTHESIS

If employees receive accessible, role-specific and responsible AI learning — combined with structured practice and real workplace application — they may become more capable of integrating AI into their work and adapting as AI-enabled work evolves.

Final indicators, instruments and evaluation design would be developed with appropriate technical and monitoring expertise.

Morocco → Evidence → MENA

Start small. Measure rigorously. Learn honestly. Scale what works.

From a Local Initiative to a Potential Regional Model



AN INVITATION TO EXPLORE — WHAT WE ARE SEEKING

01

Strategic Guidance

Where could this initiative best fit within existing workforce and digital-skills ecosystems?

02

Expert Feedback

How can the proposed framework and pilot design be strengthened?

03

Pilot Pathways

Where could the approach be tested with appropriate participants and partners?

04

Technical Collaboration

How can measurement, evaluation and responsible AI practices be strengthened?

05

Institutional Connections

Which programmes or networks could help explore regional relevance?

Why this conversation matters. The challenge of AI and work is too large for any single individual or organization to solve alone. Our contribution is intentionally focused: develop a practical Arabic-first pathway that helps employees move from AI awareness to meaningful workplace capability — and test whether it works. We are open to learning, adapting the model, and collaborating with organizations that bring complementary expertise, evidence and implementation capacity.

Designed from Morocco. Informed by global evidence. Built for Arabic-speaking workplaces. Open to MENA.

Start small. Measure rigorously. Learn honestly. Scale what works.

Lahcen Afaadas

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ARABIC-FIRST • MULTILINGUAL COLLABORATION

Developed primarily in Arabic while drawing on global research, and engaging internationally through Arabic, French and English-supported communication where appropriate.

Selected evidence sources: Deloitte — 2026 Global Human Capital Trends • The Conference Board — AI Skilling / Workforce Research, 2026 • World Bank — Morocco Digital Transformation Acceleration Program, 2026 • ILO-ESCWA — Artificial Intelligence and Employment Futures for the Arab Region, 2026 • ILO — Navigating the digital and AI revolution in Arab labour markets, 2025